

Abhijit Tagade

CONTACT INFORMATION	LSE Department of Economics Sir Arthur Lewis Building, London WC2A 3PH EMAIL: a.tagade@lse.ac.uk WEBPAGE: atagade.com	PLACEMENT DIRECTOR: Matthias Doepke EMAIL: m.doepke@lse.ac.uk ADMINISTRATOR: Emma Taverner EMAIL: e.taverner@lse.ac.uk	
EDUCATION	London School of Economics, Ph.D. in Economics Harvard University, Department of Economics, Fellow <i>Hosts:</i> Xavier Gabaix, Raj Chetty Paris School of Economics / EHESS, Master A.P.E. <i>Fields:</i> Theory, economic history; <i>Advisor:</i> Thomas Piketty Columbia University, M.A. in Economics and Education University of Madras, B.Sc. in Mathematics	Expected 2027 2024 2020 2017 2013	
FIELDS	Applied macroeconomics, innovation, public economics, finance		
REFERENCES	Professor Philippe Aghion Collège de France, INSEAD London School of Economics philippe.aghion@insead.edu	Professor Xavier Jaravel Department of Economics London School of Economics x.jaravel@lse.ac.uk	Professor John Van Reenen Department of Economics London School of Economics j.vanreenen@lse.ac.uk
JOB MARKET PAPER	Creation, Destruction and the Social Value of Innovations. ABSTRACT: Whether a market economy does too little research or too much depends on how much value innovators create and destroy for other firms. I build new measures of the private and external value of more than 3 million patents granted to U.S.-listed firms from 1980 to 2024, using the stock market’s reaction to each grant. I find that innovations create twice as much value as their owners capture. The value created for other firms has grown as a share of GDP. Sectors differ widely in how much rivalry erodes the gains from technology spillovers, which matters for competition and innovation policy. The measures of social value predict firms’ operating performance in subsequent years. To interpret these results, I develop a general equilibrium model of production and technology networks with Bertrand competition. The model separates an innovation’s effect on GDP from its effect on how profits are divided among firms, and shows that stock returns measure only the latter.		
WORKING PAPERS	Who Certifies the Machine: Limits to Gains from AI-Assisted Work. (2026) ABSTRACT: AI lowers the cost of generating output, but not the cost of certifying it. We study a worker who can either produce a task directly or delegate it to AI and repair the output, while bearing a reputation cost for certifying output that proves to be wrong. Optimal behavior sorts non-monotonically in task difficulty: the worker delegates and repairs the easiest tasks, produces intermediate ones directly, delegates the hardest tasks and verifies them up to their ability, and declines to either produce or delegate what they cannot understand. This opens a wedge between what is “shipped” and what is “warranted”: as AI assistance improves, the binding constraint shifts to what the worker can certify. Productivity need not rise and worker effort need not fall with improvements in AI, as the worker’s own ability to produce and discriminate output becomes important. Yet the same mechanism can make deskilling privately rational, as ever more effort is needed to verify increasingly correct-looking output. We present a few extensions: the gains from breaking complex tasks into simpler pieces, the non-diversifiability of risk from latent defects in AI, and implications for jobs as bundles of tasks that vary in complexity. On the Shoulders of Giants: Financial Spillovers in Innovation Networks. (2025) With Bijan Aghdasi. <i>CEP Discussion Paper 2117</i> . (Link)		

ABSTRACT: Do markets price knowledge spillovers? We show that patent grants influence the stock returns of firms that are connected through technological knowledge dependencies. Using directed patent citations among publicly listed companies in the United States, we construct a granular measure of each firm's exposure to new patents granted to its technologically upstream firms. Patents granted to these upstream companies significantly boost its abnormal stock returns during the week of the grant. We find that these financial spillovers are predominantly localized within a firm's immediate technological connections. Additionally, we provide a novel empirical decomposition of financial spillovers generated from patent grants, by distinguishing those spillovers emerging from sources of technological knowledge, from those emerging from product market rivals (negative effect) and suppliers (positive effect). Our findings are robust to alternative specifications and placebo tests, and they suggest that technological knowledge spillovers create important market-priced ties between firms that are not fully captured by traditional product market relationships.

Innovation Networks and Business-Stealing. (2023)

With Philippe Aghion, Matthew O. Jackson and Antoine Mayerowitz.
CEPR Discussion Paper 17911. ([Link](#))

ABSTRACT: We use the universe of US Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO) data on patents and inventors from 1976 to 2017 to look at how inventors' potential concern for business-stealing affects coauthorship on patents. First, we find an inverted-U shape in the fraction of coauthors that an inventor has per year who are new as a function number of other inventors also working in an inventor's field. Second, we find that after a breakthrough invention, an inventor brings in persistently fewer than usual new coauthors. Third, a higher potential concern for business stealing—as measured either by the number of others working or the average price markups by firms in the area—leads to a higher drop in the fraction of new co-authors per patent after a breakthrough. We show how these patterns can be explained via a simple model in which inventors trade off gains from collaboration against threats of business stealing.

WORKS IN PROGRESS Adoption of Innovations.

With Xavier Jaravel and Josh Lerner.

ABSTRACT: Growth models often assume that new products reach and benefit every consumer, but evidence on adoption and its benefits across consumers covers only a few product categories. We survey U.S. adults about 169 innovations in 16 areas of daily life, recording whether and when they adopted each one and how it changed their own lives and society. Perceived impact follows a power law: the top five percent of products and services account for most of the above-average private and social impact, and for more than half of the variation in private impact. Groups that differ by income, education, age or race disagree about which innovations matter most. We link the innovations to patents, firms and venture funding, and find that venture investment flows disproportionately toward the products and services consumers value most.

Network Effects under Measurement Errors.

With Isaac Meza and Yu-Jia Wang.

ABSTRACT: When social and economic networks are mismeasured, standard estimates of network effects are biased, and the effects are only partially identified. We model the observed network as a known but non-invertible map of the true network and study identification of linear and nonlinear network effects under a general class of mismeasurements. Computing the sharp identified set requires a search over every true network consistent with the observed one, which can be intractable when the mismeasurement is nonlinear. We instead build a robust identified set on a Wasserstein ball around the observed network. It never inverts the measurement process and requires only a bound on the distance between the observed and true networks. The robust set is bounded under a full-rank condition, which nonlinear network effects can satisfy without auxiliary information on the true network. We characterize both sets in closed form for the linear-in-means model with exogenous peer effects and thresholded

links, and give a data-driven radius that guarantees the robust set contains the true effect. In simulations, the sharp set contains the true effect while the naive estimate misses it.

PUBLICATIONS	Innovation Networks and Business-Stealing. (2023) (Link) <i>The Economics of Creative Destruction</i>, Harvard University Press, ed. Ufuk Akcigit and John Van Reenen. With Matthew O. Jackson and Antoine Mayerowitz. Analytical Tools in Private Equity: Return Bridge. (2019) (Link) <i>Harvard Business School Background Note 220-019</i>. With Victoria Ivashina. Valuation Techniques in Private Equity: LBO Model. (2018) (Link) <i>Harvard Business School Background Note 218-106</i>. With Victoria Ivashina and Alexey Tuzikov. Clayton, Dubilier & Rice at 40. (2018) (Link) <i>Harvard Business School Case 819-055</i>. With Josh Lerner and Terrence Shu.	
AFFILIATIONS	External collaborator, Google DeepMind Associate, Opportunity Insights, Harvard University CEP and Programme on Innovation and Diffusion, LSE	
AWARDS	AEJ: Applied Economics, Excellence in Refereeing Award 2026 LSE Class Teaching Bonus Awards 2025, 2026 Michio Morishima Fund, STICERD 2024, 2025 Doctoral Fellowship, Department of Economics, LSE 2021 Annual Fund Scholar, Columbia University 2015 Indian National Mathematical Olympiad (top ~ 300 from India) 2009	
REFEREEING	<i>AEJ: Applied Economics</i>	
PRESENTATIONS (* by coauthor)	2026: European Finance Association; Econometric Society ESM; EEA Summer Meeting; Econometric Society NASM; POID; Network Science in Economics (plenary session); HEC Paris PhD conference 2025: Econometric Society World Congress; CEP Annual Conference; LBS TADC; Warwick PhD conference; Cambridge Janeway Networks workshop 2024: Harvard Macro Lunch; HBS Finance Lunch; European Association of Young Economists; NSF Network Science in Economics; INSEAD-Collège de France; Workshop on Entrepreneurial Finance and Innovation (student workshop) 2020-23: Economics of Creative Destruction conference*; HBS Entrepreneurial Management*; KCL-College de France; World Inequality Conference, PSE; INSEAD-Collège de France; HEC Finance Doctoral Workshop*	
TEACHING (TA for)	PhD LSE, Static Optimization and Fixed Points (Francesco Nava) Fall 2025 LSE, Dynamic Programming and Differential Equations (Dimitry Mukhin) Fall 2025 LSE, Graduate Workshop on Networks; Instructor, co-organizer Summer 2024 LBS, Microeconomic Theory (Emre Ozdenoren, Jean-Pierre Benoit) Fall, Spring 2022-24 Masters LSE, Macroeconomics (Matthias Doepke) Fall 2025 SciencesPo, Microeconomics for Decision Makers (Charles P. Oman) Spring 2021 SciencesPo, Political Economy of International Development (Charles P. Oman) Fall 2020 SciencesPo, Global Inequality and Sustainability (Lucas Chancel) Fall 2019, 2020 Columbia University, Resource Allocation in Education (Henry M. Levin) Spring 2017 Columbia University, Economics of Education (Henry M. Levin) Fall 2016	

Undergraduate

LSE, International Economics (Isabela Manelici, Jose Vasquez)	Summer 2025
LSE, Macroeconomics II (Mohan Bijapur)	Spring 2025
LSE, Advanced Corporate Finance (Juanita Gonzalez-Urbe, Ashwini Agrawal)	Summer 2024
LSE, Microeconomics (Christopher Sandmann, Pascuale Schiraldi)	Summer 2024
LSE, Economic Reasoning (Ricardo Reis), Microeconomics I (Ronny Razin)	Fall 2022, 2023

RESEARCH	Imperial College London (Ramana Nanda)	2022
EXPERIENCE	Collège de France (predoc) (Philippe Aghion)	2020
(<i>RA for</i>)	Paris School of Economics (Olivier Compte), World Inequality Lab (Lucas Chancel)	2019
	Harvard Business School (Josh Lerner, Victoria Ivashina, Ramana Nanda)	2018
	Columbia Law School (Katharina Pistor)	2016

RESEARCH SUMMER	Econometric Society, Dynamic Structural Econometrics	2025
SCHOOLS	NBER Entrepreneurship Research Boot Camp	2024
	Israel Institute for Advanced Study (bounded rationality, imperfect cognition)	2023
	University of Chicago, Human Capital and Economic Opportunity	2018
	Institute of Mathematical Sciences, India (analytic number theory; graduate level)	2012

LSE SERVICE	Co-head, Economics PhD Applicant Mentoring Program (AMP); Labor Student Seminar
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SKILLS	Stata, R, Python, $\LaTeX$	(<i>Last updated:</i> October 2026)
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